The Unit 1 color code

Every page in Unit 1 uses the same six colors, and each color always means the same thing. **First, color each swatch below with your own pencil or marker.** Then, whenever a page asks you to color, choose the color by what the thing *is*.

HOW MOTION CHANGES	Use these for acceleration: what the change in velocity does
GREEN	**Speeding up.** v and a have the same sign; motion dots spread apart. Ex: a car leaving a green light, the trend line on an a–F graph.
RED	**Slowing down.** v and a have opposite signs; motion dots crowd together. Ex: braking, a ball rising before it peaks.
YELLOW	**Steady or balanced.** a = 0 and net force = 0, whether the object is moving or at rest. Ex: cruise control, a hanging sign.
QUANTITIES	**Use these for what you measure and draw**
BLUE	**Position and displacement.** Where it is and how far it ended up. Ex: start and finish dots, displacement arrows, area under a v–t line.
PURPLE	**Velocity.** How fast and which way. Ex: velocity arrows, v–t lines, the slope of an x–t graph.
ORANGE	**Every force.** Weight, normal, friction, tension, and pushes are all orange, so label each one W, N, f, T, or F. Draw net force as a thick orange arrow.

TWO THINGS, SAME COLOR?

Keep the color and change the line:

- solid = measured or actual
- dashed = predicted, resultant, or a part
- stripes = negative area
- light shade = a range

PENCIL · EVERYTHING ELSE

Axes, labels, data points, reference points, the path for *distance*, and anything you cross out stay in pencil.

Sorting evidence or questions? Use the **letters** the page gives (E, I, Q, P, D), not colors.

THE CHAIN, IN COLOR

NET FORCE · orange → **ACCELERATION · green / red / yellow** →

VELOCITY · purple → **POSITION · blue**

This is how the 2026-XJ desk goes from forces to a forecast of where it will arrive.